

The long *afternoon*

Four and a half hours from low water to full dark. This is the half of the day the morning window could not touch, and it holds the strongest frames on the whole list. Thirty new shots, plus every outstanding frame from session one, sequenced so the light does the work.

NEW SOLO	NEW TOGETHER	OUTSTANDING	RUNS	NEW KIT
15, S41 to S55	15, D41 to D55	About 30 from session one	2.00pm to 6.35pm	Tripod and a warm torch

THE RUNSHEET

Start at low water, finish in the dark

Timed against today's tide and sunset, which happen to fall almost perfectly for an afternoon: low water just as you arrive, sun down as you finish. If you run this on another date instead, pick one where low tide lands between 3.30 and 5.30pm, and read the daylight saving note at the bottom.

LOW TIDE	SUNSET	BLUE HOUR	DARK	SEA
2.25pm to 2.55pm	5.57pm	5.57pm to 6.35pm	About 6.40pm	13.5 degrees

- 2.00

Kitekite falls and the bush

Thirty five minutes in on foot, which is exactly why it was cut last time and exactly why it fits now. Shaded, green, cool, and the beach light is worthless at this hour anyway. Tripod goes in the pack. **New: S41 to S45, D41 to D44. Outstanding: S1 to S5, D1 to D5.**
- 3.30

Walk out, drive to North Piha, change

Wardrobe two goes on in the carpark. Dry socks now, not later, because the next block is wet.
- 3.45

Mirror sand and the lagoon

Low water has just turned, so the flats are at their widest and the water is still glass. The block that got compromised in the morning, done properly. **New: S46, S47, D45, D46. Outstanding: S6 to S11, D6 to D11.**
- 4.45

The long sweep, low sun

The sun drops into the last quarter of the sky and everything goes warm and long. Shoot down the beach at 135mm so Lion Rock stacks up behind. **New: S48 to S50, D47, D48. Outstanding: S30 to S34, D29 to D34.**
- 5.20

Sunset

Be standing in position by 5.20, not walking toward it. Forty minutes of usable colour and it does not wait. **New: S51 to S53, D49 to D51. Outstanding: S35 to S39, D35 to D39.**

6.05 Blue hour and torchlight

The half hour most people pack up for, and it is the best light of the day for this brand. Tripod out, torch on. **New: S54, S55, D52 to D54. Outstanding: S40, D40.**

6.30 Headlights, then stop

One frame in the carpark with the car doing the lighting, then everyone gets warm. **New: D55.**

Three pieces of kit this session cannot run without

A tripod, because four of the new frames are half second to four second exposures and nothing handheld will hold them. A torch with a warm beam, held off to the side by Mark rather than strapped to a head, and if it is a cold white LED then tape a scrap of orange gel or a sweet wrapper over it. And spare batteries, because cold plus long exposures plus live view will flatten a battery in an hour.

Get off the falls track before the light goes

Under that canopy it is properly dark well before it is dark on the beach, and the track has roots and steps. Out by 3.30 as scheduled, or carry two torches. Do not plan to come back to the falls at the end of the day.

You will get wet twice, so plan for it

The falls pool in block one and the shorebreak in block five. Two towels, two pairs of dry socks, and a change of trousers in the car. Sea is 13.5 degrees and the air goes cold fast after the sun drops, so the difference between a great blue hour and an abandoned one is dry clothes.

If you run this after 27 September

Daylight saving starts on the last Sunday in September, and sunset jumps from about 6pm to about 7.30pm. Shift the whole runsheet an hour and a half later: falls at 3.30, mirror sand at 5.15, sunset block at 6.50. The tide rule does not shift with the clock, so still pick a day with low water in the late afternoon.

Wardrobe, two changes

Bush block: cream linen and camel, the same soft palette as session one, because green wants warm against it. Beach blocks: rust or terracotta knit and cream trousers for the low sun, then pull on the dark coats for sunset and after. Head to toe dark is correct from 5.20 onward and wrong before it.

What to cut if you fall behind

The falls block, in full. It is the only one that can move to another day without losing anything, because it does not depend on the tide or the sunset. Everything from 4.45 onward is unrepeatable without another whole trip, so protect it. If the sky is flat grey at 5pm, skip the sunset frames rather than shooting them badly, and put that time into blue hour instead, which works under cloud.

NEW FRAMES

Thirty shots the middle of the day cannot give you

These are additions to the master list, not repeats. Every one depends on either moving water, low sun, or dark, which is why none of them appear in session one. Numbering carries on from the original list so nothing collides.

BLOCK 9

2.00

Kitekite falls and the bush

LIGHT

Deep shade, cool green, occasional shafts through the canopy

LOOK

Cream linen and camel. Bare feet at the pool, boots on the track.

KIT

Tripod, and a neutral density filter if the canopy is bright

JUST YOU

☐ S41 Still at the pool edge, water silk behind

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · TRIPOD · QUARTER SECOND

You have to be genuinely still for this, so find something to lean on. The falls go to silk and you stay sharp. That contrast is the whole frame, and it is the only one on either list that needs a tripod in daylight.

FOR Course page, the stillness section

☐ S42 In a shaft of light under the canopy

VERTICAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Wait for the sun to break through the nikau. It comes and goes in seconds, so get set up and be ready rather than trying to find it. Face up into it, eyes closed.

FOR Homepage warmth band, blog

☐ S43 Feet in the pool on the rock ledge

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Sit on the ledge with your feet actually in it. It is cold and that will show on your face, which is fine, it is the honest version of a wellness photo.

FOR Retreat page, blog

☐ S44 Wet hair pushed back

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM WIDE OPEN

Splash your face, push the cut straight back with both hands, water out of focus behind you. The wet version of the haircut, and it looks nothing like the wind version.

FOR The cut, wet · social

☐ S45 Small on the track, huge ferns

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM

Walking away up the track with punga ferns towering over you. Scale is the point, so get me a lot of fern and very little you.

FOR Full bleed band with copy over

YOU AND MARK

☐ D41 Both at the base, looking up

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM

Stand together at the bottom of the falls and look up at it. Tiny people, enormous water. Do not look at me and do not look at each other.

FOR Retreat hero, full bleed

☐ D42 He behind her, both facing the water

VERTICAL · THREE QUARTER · 85MM

His arms round her from behind, both watching the falls. Shot from the side so it reads as two people sharing a view rather than a posed embrace.

FOR Homepage, About us

☐ D43 Feet in, laughing at the cold

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 35MM

Both on the ledge, feet in the pool, and it is genuinely freezing. Do not manage the reaction, just let me shoot it.

FOR Social, events

☐ D44 Silhouetted in the fern tunnel

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM · EXPOSED FOR THE LIGHT BEYOND

Find the stretch of track where the ferns close over and there is bright green at the far end. Walk into it. You both go to shape against the light.

FOR Dark section, quote background

LIGHT

Sun getting lower and warmer, still well up. Side light across the flats.

LOOK

Rust or terracotta knit, cream trousers, bare feet, trousers rolled

NOTE

Low water has just turned, so the flats are as wide as they get today

JUST YOU

☐ S46 Standing in the stream cut

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 50MM

Where the lagoon stream cuts across the beach, stand in the middle of it with the water running round your ankles. Moving water at your feet, still everything else.

FOR Course page, quiz opt in

☐ S47 The compressed reflection

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 135MM · CAMERA VERY LOW

Same reflection idea as S6 but from a long way back with the long lens, so you and the mirrored you stack up tight in the middle of a huge flat plane. Very different picture from the wide version.

FOR Hero banner, art frame

YOU AND MARK

☐ D45 Palm to palm, both reflected

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · SYMMETRICAL · LOW CAMERA

Facing each other, hands up and pressed palm to palm, both of you doubled in the water underneath. Keep a gap between your bodies so the shape stays clean.

FOR Therapy page, intensives

☐ D46 Single file up the stream cut

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

Walking up the middle of the stream, you first, him following, both watching your footing. Nobody performing, two reflections trailing.

FOR Wanaka retreat, homepage

BLOCK 11

4.45

The long sweep, low sun

LIGHT

The good hour. Long, warm, low, with spray haze doing the diffusion.

LOOK

As block 10, coats to hand for the moment it turns cold

LENS

135mm for almost everything, 24mm for the shadow frames

JUST YOU

☐

S48

Your own shadow, thirty feet long

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM · CAMERA HELD HIGH

Late sun throws a shadow far longer than you are tall. Compose for the shadow as the subject, with you small at the top of the frame. Odd, graphic, and nothing else on the list looks like it.

FOR Blog, art frame, social

☐

S49

Hair as a halo of gold wire

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM

Sun directly behind your head, exposed for the face so the cut lights up as a rim of gold all round. This is the frame that makes short hair look like a decision rather than a change.

FOR Course hero, podcast art

☐

S50

Walking away, looking back

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · 135MM

Coat open and moving, walking away from me, then turn and look back over the shoulder without stopping. Six or seven goes, it is a hard one to get right.

FOR Homepage portrait, For Her hero

YOU AND MARK

☐

D47

Two shadows merging

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 24MM · CAMERA HIGH

Stand a little apart and let the two long shadows overlap on the sand. Bodies right at the top of the frame, shadows filling the rest. A picture about two people becoming one shape without a single face in it.

FOR Therapy page, dark band, quote background

☐

D48

He photographs her on his phone

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 85MM

Exactly what couples actually do on a beach. He takes a photo, you laugh at him taking it, I photograph both of you. The most honest frame in the session.

FOR Social, About us, email

LIGHT

Forty minutes, and it changes every five. Sunset 5.57.

LOOK

Dark coats on. Head to toe dark is correct from here.

NOTE

Be in position at 5.20, not walking toward it. Shoot fast, review later.

JUST YOU

☐ S51 Ankle deep in orange foam

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · 85MM

Standing in the last of the shorebreak with the whole surface of the water gone orange around you. Ankle depth and no further, and keep facing the sea so nothing surprises you.

FOR *Closing band, retreat page*

☐ S52 Profile with the sun beside your face

VERTICAL · HEAD AND SHOULDERS · 135MM OR LONGER

Line yourself up so the sun sits just beside your cheek on the horizon, like a full stop next to the profile. Move a step at a time until it lands, and shoot in the last five minutes when the disc is soft enough to look at.

FOR *Podcast cover, press*

☐ S53 Sitting, watching it go

HORIZONTAL · VERY WIDE · 35MM · FROM BEHIND

Sit down on the sand and watch it, small in a very big frame. No direction beyond that. It is the last quiet frame of the day and it should look like nobody asked you to do it.

FOR *Footer, closing band, email*

YOU AND MARK

☐ D49 He lifts her hand, she turns under it

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · SILHOUETTE

The shape of a slow dance rather than an actual one. He raises a hand, you turn underneath it. Keep it slow so the silhouette stays readable, and keep daylight between your bodies.

FOR *Events, retreat, homepage*

☐ D50 Flat on your backs, heads together

HORIZONTAL · FROM DIRECTLY ABOVE · 35MM

Both lying on the sand, crowns of your heads almost touching, bodies going opposite ways. I shoot straight down with the last colour in the sky reflected on your faces. Bring the towel to lie on.

FOR *About us, course cross sell, social*

☐ D51 The kiss, in full silhouette

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · WATERLINE · EXPOSED FOR SKY

This is where the actual kiss goes, and nowhere earlier. In silhouette it reads as shape and privacy. In daylight it reads as an engagement shoot. Same picture, completely different meaning.

FOR *Homepage hero, the tender one*

BLOCK 13

6.05

Blue hour and torchlight

LIGHT

Deep blue ambient falling fast, plus one warm torch you control

LOOK

Coats and the blanket. Whatever is warm.

KIT

Tripod up, torch on, low ISO. Mark holds the light at 45 degrees.

JUST YOU

☐ S54 Torch lit against deep blue

VERTICAL · CHEST UP · 85MM · WARM LIGHT FROM CAMERA LEFT

Everything behind you goes cold blue and your face stays warm. Mark holds the torch out to the side and slightly above, never straight on. Move it around until the shadow under the cheekbone looks right.

FOR Podcast cover, the moody portrait

☐ S55 Two seconds, the sea gone to mist

VERTICAL · FULL LENGTH · TRIPOD · TWO SECONDS

You stand completely still while the water blurs to smoke around you. Brace against something and hold your breath through the exposure. Expect to bin half of them, the keepers are worth it.

FOR Art frame, dark section, blog

YOU AND MARK

☐ D52 Torch low between you, everything else blue

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 50MM

Both inside the blanket with the torch held low between your chests, lighting the two faces from underneath and nothing else. Warm faces in a cold world, which is the entire brand in one frame.

FOR Newsletter, retreat, homepage

☐ D53 Four seconds, both still

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · TRIPOD · FOUR SECONDS

Both of you holding still while the sea turns to smoke behind. Lean into each other, it makes staying still much easier. Count it out loud so you both know when it ends.

FOR Full bleed band, retreat page

☐ D54 Walking off with the torch beam showing

HORIZONTAL · FULL LENGTH · ONE SECOND · TRIPOD

Walking away up the beach with the torch on, so the beam draws a line through the frame. Slow shutter so the light streaks and you both go soft. Last frame on the sand.

FOR Footer, closing band

BLOCK 14

6.30

Headlights, then stop

LIGHT

Car headlights as the only source. Everything outside the beam is black.

LOOK

Coats, blanket, thermos, cold hands

NOTE

One frame. Then heater on and go and get dinner.

YOU AND MARK

☐ D55

Leaning on the car in the headlights

HORIZONTAL · WAIST UP · 50MM · LIT BY HEADLIGHTS ONLY

Both leaning on the bonnet with the lights on, steam coming off the thermos, nothing visible behind you but black. Cold, tired, done, and it will be one of the warmest pictures of the day.

FOR *About us, social, the closing frame*

CARRIED OVER

What session one left on the table

Slot these into the blocks above as the runsheet indicates. If the morning went to plan you will already have most of the first two rows, so check before you re-shoot.

BLOCK IT BELONGS IN	SOLO	TOGETHER
Block 9, the falls and bush	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5	D1, D2, D3, D4, D5
Block 10, mirror sand	S6, S7, S8, S9, S10, S11	D6, D7, D8, D9, D10, D11
Block 11, the long sweep	S30, S31, S32, S33, S34	D29, D30, D31, D32, D33, D34
Block 12, sunset	S35, S36, S37, S38, S39	D35, D36, D37, D38, D39
Block 13, blue hour	S40	D40
Anywhere, if not already shot	S12 to S29	D12 to D28

The rock block, S12 to S17 and D12 to D17, needs a falling tide and should not be attempted late in this session. If it is still outstanding, do it at the start of a third trip rather than squeezing it in here.

IF THE LIGHT COLLAPSES

The eight frames this session exists for

Grey sky, a squall, a late start. Get these and the trip has paid for itself.

- D37 foreheads together with the sun burning between your chests. The signature couple frame, and it has been outstanding since day one.
- S39 the last orange light on your face. The strongest solo portrait available anywhere on either list.
- S49 the hair halo. The frame that makes the haircut look like a decision.
- D51 the kiss in silhouette. The only place on the whole list where an actual kiss works.
- D47 two long shadows merging. No faces, and it says more about the work than most of the portraits do.
- S53 sitting watching it go. Your closing band and your footer, in one honest frame.
- D52 torch low between you in the blue. Warm faces in a cold world.
- S41 still at the falls with the water gone to silk. The only frame on either list that could not be taken on a beach.

Flat grey does not kill this session, it just moves the weight. Cloud ruins the sunset block and improves the falls, the mirror sand and the blue hour, all three of which work better without hard sun. Only rain heavy enough to threaten the camera is worth turning back for.